ANKUR SHEEL

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SUMMARY

I'm a backend engineer who genuinely cares about making things run better. My background is a mix of fast-paced startup environments and the structured complexity of large-scale enterprises. I love building tools that save my teammates time. I'm the person you bring in when a project is stuck in a debugging nightmare or needs a serious refactor to stay maintainable. When I'm not writing unit tests or fixing backend logic, I'm usually building my own side projects and blogging about whatever new tech I've picked up

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer - Atlassian

Remote (Auckland) | Nov 2022 - Mar 2026
Technology: Java, REST, TypeScript, React

Worked in the Jira Issue Backend Platform team (~30 engineers, billions of requests/day).

- Led initiatives from design to delivery, improving core platform performance with sub-teams of 3-4 developers.
- Reduced Jira attachment load latency by 90ms at P90 through frontend and backend optimisations.
- Increased Issue Create API reliability by implementing idempotent retries. The underlying infrastructure was later used to make other REST APIs idempotent.
- Implemented support for renaming Jira projects containing large numbers of issues, removing a long-standing operational limitation.
- Built an IntelliJ plugin to simplify feature flag cleanup and added annotations to prevent dead code during flag removal.
- Built a Forge app reducing feature-flag rollout preparation from 20 minutes to 5 minutes.
- Mentored junior engineers.
- Multiple internal blogs, some of which have been sanitized and cross-posted on my personal site.

Senior Software Engineer - First AML

Auckland, New Zealand | Nov 2019 - Oct 2022
Technology: C#, GraphQL

Joined as the second backend engineer and the 12th employee. Helped grow Product & Engineering team to 20+ members.

- Automated identity verification workflow, cutting analyst time from 5+ minutes to <1 minute per verification.
- Designed and developed entity-copy functionality, reducing task time from 20+ minutes to seconds.
- Built email integrations to power the forms sent to end users. I also created a Slack integration to notify analysts if an email could not be sent due to bounce or complaint errors.
- Built backend feature flag system enabling safer releases and smaller PRs, plus open-source CLI for flag management.
- Migrated backend GraphQL implementation from GraphQL.NET to HotChocolate and established API conventions.
- Ran introductory sessions for Insomnia and feature flags for engineers new to the tooling.
- Introduced developer productivity initiatives: No-Meeting Thursdays, retrospectives, lunch-and-learns.
- Multiple internal blogs some of which have been sanitized and cross-posted on my personal site.

Earlier Career (2005–2019)

Technology: C#, GraphQL, VisualBasic, C++, COBOL

Pushpay, Vista Entertainment Solutions, Gameloft (New Zealand), Knowledge Adventure India Private Ltd, BlueGiant Interactive Private Ltd, Trine Game Studios, Dhruva Interactive, Perot Systems (India)

SELECTED PERSONAL PROJECTS

- Wordxplorer: Wordle-style educational game for children built with Unity and C#, published on the App Store and Google Play.
- xUnitHelpers: helper library that simplifies writing tests with xUnit.
- FeatureFlagHelper: CLI tool for modifying feature flag JSON files across multiple environments.
- StatiqHelpers: wrapper around Statiq.Web to build my static websites.

You can find more projects at ***https://www.ankursheel.com/cv***

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Computer Science — University of Southern California, Los Angeles, USA
Bachelor of Science, Computer Science and Engineering — Manipal Institute of Technology, Manipal, India